FinTech Expo Fall 2026 Workflow & Pitch Guide

From idea to prototype, evaluation rubric, demo plan, feasibility, and judge Q&A;

Prepared for FinTech Expo Fall 2026

This guide preserves the FinTech Expo workflow and rubric, and adds a direct mapping to AuditGuard, a recommended live demo, judge Q&A preparation, and feasibility points.

Original FinTech Expo workflow and rubric

From Idea to Pitch: Workflow for FinTech/Automation Projects

FinTech Expo Fall 2026 — Student Guide

Workflow (8 Steps)

1. **Identify the Problem** — Pick a real pain point in taxation, finance, accounting, audit, or risk (from your own experience, a business, or research).
2. **Research & Validate** — Study existing solutions, literature, and talk to 2–3 potential users to confirm the problem is real and worth solving.
3. **Ideate the Solution** — Decide the format: research paper, automation tool, or FinTech app. Sketch how it works end-to-end.
4. **Design the Solution** — Map the process flow / user journey; list features, data needed, and tools/tech stack (Excel macros, Python, app builder, etc.).
5. **Build a Prototype/MVP** — Create a working demo, mockup, spreadsheet model, or app screen — doesn't need to be fully functional, just demonstrable.
6. **Test & Refine** — Get feedback from a peer or teacher; fix gaps; check accuracy of calculations/logic.
7. **Financial & Feasibility Check** — Estimate cost to build, potential users/market size, and revenue or savings it creates.
8. **Build the Pitch** — Create a short deck (Problem → Solution → Demo → Market → Financials → Ask) and rehearse a 5–7 minute pitch + Q&A.

20-Mark Evaluation Rubric

Tip for students: Judges weight Innovation (4) and Research/Feasibility (6 combined) the highest — spend the most prep time there, not just on slide design.

AuditGuard mapping to the rubric

Problem: spreadsheet sampling is slow and difficult to explain. Research: validate with auditors/finance users and cite audit-control context. Innovation: six explainable rules, Benford screening, calendar analytics, grounded explanations, and accuracy reporting. Feasibility: local processing, existing Excel workflow, optional Groq, and a production roadmap. Demo: upload, Overview, Flagged Entries, Calendar, AI Insights, Export & Accuracy.

Recommended 5-7 minute demo

1) Explain the problem. 2) Upload the blind workbook or press Load Demo Data. 3) Show 606 rows and 57 flagged. 4) Investigate Self-Approval and Duplicate. 5) Show Calendar. 6) Show deterministic AI Insights and explain Groq safety. 7) Show Excel export and labelled accuracy. 8) Close with target users, illustrative pricing, limitations, and roadmap.

Judge Q&A preparation

Be ready to answer: Is this machine learning? No; deterministic rules plus Benford statistics. How are false positives handled? Accuracy metrics report them when labels exist. Where does data go? Local by default. Can AI hallucinate? Number grounding rejects invented numbers and falls back to templates. Why Benford? It directs sampling and is not proof. Biggest limitation? Duplicate matching lacks a first-class invoice key. What comes next? Invoice/PO matching, reviewer workflow, immutable trail, multi-entity, SSO, and ERP connectors.

Pitch preparation checklist

Run both labelled and blind workbooks, pre-download the Excel report, keep screenshots, keep Groq off unless tested, rehearse within 5-7 minutes, and label market/pricing figures as illustrative assumptions unless independently validated.